be eligible for vaccination due to age or pre-existing conditions, so we would have to identify these folks and exclude them from the vaccination programme; some vaccines may require multiple doses and the app created would have to be able to monitor this digitally per individual.

In his concluding remarks, Mr Sharma pitched to the prime minister that the government must invest in a scalable vaccination digital health infrastructure, as it would be critical for India to be self-reliant and resilient to absorb future shocks similar to COVID-19.

The prime minister shared his vision for COVID-19 vaccination with him, and technology formed its backbone. The PM wanted to ensure that the drive remained accessible, equal and neutral for every Indian irrespective of their class, caste, reach and financial status. According to the PM, the speed and scale of India's election process is a unique expertise that India has developed and there are very few countries that even come close. Using the same learnings and approach, India could create an important tool for vaccination. PM asked him to immediately get going and create a platform that could become a model for the world.

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3 JULY 2020

INDIA | 2,36,836 ACTIVE CASES | 18,734 DEATHS

WORLD | 37,57,516 ACTIVE CASES | 5,78,433 DEATHS

Three Corps Commander-level meetings had taken place following the Galwan Valley stand-off in which 20 Indian soldiers attained martyrdom. The last one as recent as 30 June was when both sides had decided to disengage troops in a phased manner. Both sides had been throwing accusations at each other holding the other responsible for crossing the poorly demarcated border and provoking the fight. Immediately after the clash, the prime minister, in a televised address had assured the Indians that Indian military was fully capable of defending our borders and that they had been given a free hand to take all necessary steps to protect the Indian territory. He had added that after the clash, no foreign soldiers were inside Indian borders and none of our territory had been lost or captured.[6]

However, in a surprise visit, in the early hours of the morning on 3 July, the prime minister accompanied by the Chief of Defence Staff (CDS)